

Local Music Organizer

User Guide - Early Access macOS Utility for Local Music.app Libraries

Version target: 0.3 Early Access

macOS 14 Sonoma or later

Apple Silicon recommended - Intel supported in Universal builds

Read this first

Local Music Organizer is designed for careful users with large local Music.app libraries. Keep backups before cleanup, tag editing, Repair / Convert, File Maintenance, or any operation that changes Music.app records or local files.



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1. What Local Music Organizer is for

Local Music Organizer is a macOS utility for users with large local Music.app libraries. It is designed for local files, real playlists, long-term music collections, and careful maintenance work. It is not a streaming service manager, not a cloud Apple Music replacement, and not a one-click deletion tool.

- Inspect Music.app library quality, missing files, missing artwork, bitrate, codec, sample rate, duration, and outlier records.
- Compare playlists and find shared tracks, repeated entries, and exact same local files.
- Find where a track is used before editing, removing, repairing, or moving files.
- Use Warm Cache to make repeated scans on large libraries faster after the first read.
- Repair or convert compatible copies for difficult local audio formats when helper tools are installed.
- Build smarter shuffle-style playlists with fewer repeated artist or album clusters.

2. Trial mode

The app can be opened without an active license. Trial mode is intentionally limited, but useful enough to verify that the app can read a real Music.app playlist and analyze local tracks from your library.

- Trial mode allows one playlist at a time.
- Trial scans are limited to up to 50 local tracks.
- Full-library scans, unlimited playlist analysis, cleanup actions, Repair / Convert, and File Maintenance require Early Access activation.
- Trial mode remains available even if a license is not activated or has been revoked.

3. License and activation

Early Access activation requires an internet connection. The license is generated manually for the buyer email and the Mac Hardware ID shown in the License screen of the app.

1. Open Local Music Organizer and go to the License screen.
2. Enter the buyer email used for purchase.
3. Click Copy License Request.
4. Send the request to sergeyappleservice@gmail.com.
5. Wait for the manual license key. Delivery may take several hours depending on time zone differences.
6. Enter the license key and activate online.

License server checks

- The app checks license status during activation.
- The app checks license status at startup.
- While the app is running, it checks license status periodically, currently about every 60 minutes.
- If the license server is temporarily unavailable, the last successful active check allows up to 24 hours of offline use.
- If the license is revoked after a refund, chargeback, payment dispute, fraud review, or manual admin action, full-version access may stop during a future license check.

Privacy note

For license validation, the app may send the buyer email, Mac Hardware ID, license key, app version, and basic license status data to the license server. This is used only for activation, license validation, fraud prevention, refund handling, support, and troubleshooting.

4. macOS permissions

Some features require macOS permissions. If a scan returns no data, cannot read playlists, or cannot access files, check permissions first.

Music.app automation permission

- Required for reading Music.app playlists and library records.
- Required for tag editing and playlist entry removal workflows.
- If macOS blocks automation, open System Settings -> Privacy & Security -> Automation and allow Local Music Organizer to control Music.app.

Full Disk Access

- May be required for file and folder checks, missing file scans, log export, and physical folder comparisons.
- Open System Settings -> Privacy & Security -> Full Disk Access and add Local Music Organizer if file access is incomplete.

Network access

- Required for activation and license status checks.
- Required when the app opens Terminal installers that download Homebrew packages or helper tools.

5. Safety rules and backups

Large local music libraries are valuable. Do not start cleanup work without a backup. A Time Machine backup is useful, but a separate copy of the Music folder and important audio folders is better before major maintenance.

- Scans are generally read-only until you press a specific action button.
- Playlist removal actions remove playlist entries, not physical audio files.
- Tag edits are explicit and are sent to Music.app.
- Supported tag edits and playlist removals may have Undo, but a backup is still required.
- Repair / Convert should create compatible copies; do not delete originals until you have reviewed results.

6. Warm Cache

Music.app automation can be slow with thousands of tracks and many playlists. Warm Cache reads expensive Music.app data once and reuses it across tools.

- Full Library Records Cache feeds Dashboard, Quality checks, Library Duplicates, File Maintenance, and fast library searches.
- Light Music Library Cache feeds Library Map, Track Usage, and repeated library matching operations.
- Playlist Membership Cache feeds Playlist Compare, Playlist Duplicates, Track Usage, Health Check, and playlist usage protection.
- For large collections, let Warm Cache finish before heavy scans.

7. Library Dashboard

Library Dashboard gives a read-only overview of the library. It helps identify suspicious records before cleanup.

- Records scanned, empty artists, low bitrate tracks, missing artwork, missing files, long tracks, codec/container information, storage clues, and outliers.
- Use Dashboard before deleting, moving, or converting anything.
- Full-library dashboard scans require Early Access activation.

8. Playlist tools: duplicates, compare, usage

Playlist Duplicates

Finds repeated entries inside one playlist. In trial mode, this is limited to one playlist and up to 50 local tracks. Removal affects the playlist entry only; it does not delete the audio file and does not delete the Music library record.

Playlist Compare

Compares two playlists and shows shared tracks. Use it to find overlap, repeated curation, or tracks that appear in both a source and target playlist. Removal should remove only the playlist entry from the selected side.

Track Usage

Searches for a track or file and shows every playlist where it is used. This is important before deleting, renaming, repairing, moving, or replacing local files.

9. Library Duplicates and Quality Duplicates

Library Duplicates

Finds Music.app library records pointing to the same local file or exact duplicate candidates. Use it to identify unused duplicate records and protect playlist usage.

Quality Duplicates

Helps compare multiple versions of similar tracks. It may use signals such as bitrate, codec, sample rate, file size, duration, and metadata similarity. It should be used as a review tool, not as automatic deletion.

10. Health Check and Artwork Check

Health Check

- Find missing files and inaccessible paths.
- Find empty metadata and suspicious library records.
- Compare Music.app references with files under a chosen physical root.
- Identify orphan physical files that are under a folder but not found in selected playlists or references.

Artwork Check

Finds tracks or albums with missing artwork. Artwork access through Music.app can be slower than light metadata scans, so artwork checking is separated from faster tools.

11. Audio Inspector and audio quality tools

Audio Inspector opens a local audio file and shows technical information. Use it before conversion or when trying to understand an unusual file.

- Format, container, sample rate, bit depth, bitrate, channels, duration, and file size.
- Raw ainfo data when available.
- Spectrogram-style visual inspection for rough quality review.
- Use Check Codec Support to see what your FFmpeg build reports as supported.

12. Repair / Convert overview

Repair / Convert is for libraries with mixed formats, legacy files, old imports, cue sheets, audiophile files, and files that may not work well in Music.app. The goal is to create compatible copies while preserving originals.

- Original files should not be silently overwritten.
- Converted files should be reviewed before replacing anything.
- Some workflows require helper tools that are not included with macOS.

- The app can open Terminal installers for common helper tools, but the user remains responsible for approving installations.

Preservation rule

Do not replace your original archive files until you have created, inspected, and listened to the converted copy. For rare formats, keep the original source even if a compatible Music.app copy is created.

13. Homebrew, Command Line Tools, and helper installation order

Homebrew is used by many Mac users to install command-line audio tools. Local Music Organizer can open Terminal-based installers for common helpers. These installers are visible to the user; the app should not silently install system tools in the background.

Recommended setup order

7. Open Repair / Convert and click Check Tools.
8. If brew is missing, click Install Homebrew.
9. If macOS asks to install Command Line Tools for Xcode, allow it and wait. This is not the full Xcode app.
10. Return to Local Music Organizer and click Open Terminal Installer for FFmpeg and LAME.
11. Click Install Old-School Helpers if you need tracker modules or WavPack helpers.
12. Click Install SACD Extract only if you use SACD ISO files.
13. Use Copy OptimFROG Notes for manual OFR/OFS decoder setup.
14. Click Check Tools again and confirm that paths are detected.

Typical Homebrew paths

- Apple Silicon default path: `/opt/homebrew/bin/brew`
- Intel Mac default path: `/usr/local/bin/brew`
- Helper executables are usually found in `/opt/homebrew/bin`, `/usr/local/bin`, or `~/local/bin`.

14. Old-school helpers: xmp, WavPack, SACD Extract

FFmpeg and LAME

FFmpeg and LAME are common helpers for audio inspection and conversion workflows. They are installed by the core Terminal installer in the app when Homebrew is available.

xmp

xmp is used for tracker/module archives such as MOD, XM, IT, and S3M when FFmpeg alone is not enough.

WavPack

WavPack support may use wavpack and wvunpack command-line tools for WV/WVC workflows.

SACD Extract

SACD Extract is needed only for SACD ISO workflows. If you do not use SACD ISO files, you do not need this helper. The app can open a Terminal installer that attempts to place `sacd_extract` in `~/local/bin`.

15. OptimFROG / OFR / OFS manual setup

OptimFROG is a rare lossless audio format. Files commonly use .ofr or .ofs extensions. Most users do not need this decoder. Local Music Organizer can detect whether an OptimFROG decoder is available, but it does not automatically install it.

Why OptimFROG is manual

- It is a rare/legacy format, not a normal standard Homebrew helper in the app workflow.
- The user should download it intentionally from the official source or another trusted source they choose.
- The app avoids silently downloading and installing uncommon third-party decoder binaries.

What to find

Download the macOS / OS X command-line OptimFROG package. After unpacking it, look for a decoder executable. Depending on the package/version, it may be named one of these:

- ofr
- ofrdec
- optimfrog

Where to put it

15. Create a local bin folder if it does not exist: `~/local/bin`
16. Copy the decoder executable into `~/local/bin/`
17. Make it executable in Terminal: `chmod +x ~/local/bin/<decoder-name>`
18. Restart Local Music Organizer or return to Repair / Convert.
19. Click Check Tools.
20. Confirm that OptimFROG decoder is no longer shown as not found.

OptimFROG preservation warning

Do not delete original .ofr or .ofs files after conversion. These may be old archive files. Keep the original source separately and review converted copies before using them in Music.app.

16. File Maintenance

File Maintenance helps reveal files in Finder, copy paths, inspect permissions, compare Music.app references with real files on disk, and understand whether library records point to accessible local media.

- Use Full Disk Access if scans cannot read folders that should be accessible.
- Be careful with permission normalization. Review what will change before confirming.
- Do not move or delete physical audio files without checking Track Usage and playlists first.

17. Tag editing, undo, logs, and reports

Supported tag edits update Music.app records. Some actions can be undone, but Undo is not a substitute for backups.

- Review visible records before editing tags.
- Use Undo immediately if an edit was wrong.
- Export or copy logs when asking for support.
- Keep reports for large cleanup sessions so you know what changed.

18. Smart Shuffle Builder

Smart Shuffle Builder is designed to create more natural listening sessions from large local collections by reducing repeated artist clusters, album blocks, and predictable patterns.

- Use it for curated local libraries where ordinary random shuffle feels repetitive.
- Review the generated list before relying on it for a long session.
- The goal is better playlist construction, not a replacement media player.

19. Troubleshooting

The app does not see Music.app playlists

- Open Music.app once and confirm your library is available.
- Check System Settings -> Privacy & Security -> Automation.
- Restart Local Music Organizer after granting permission.

File scans cannot access folders

- Grant Full Disk Access if needed.
- Check that the files are local, not cloud-only placeholders.
- Confirm external drives are mounted.

Activation fails

- Check internet connection.
- Confirm buyer email matches the license request.
- Confirm Hardware ID did not change.
- Copy/paste the serial key exactly.
- If the license was refunded or revoked, full-version activation may be disabled.

Homebrew installer mentions Command Line Tools for Xcode

This is normal on many Macs, especially clean Intel systems. It is not the full Xcode app. Wait for the Command Line Tools installer to finish, then continue with the Homebrew workflow.

OptimFROG is still not found

- Confirm the decoder executable is in ~/.local/bin, /opt/homebrew/bin, or /usr/local/bin.
- Confirm it is executable with `chmod +x`.
- Confirm the file name is one the app recognizes, such as `ofr`, `ofrdec`, or `optimfrog`.

20. Refunds, revocation, and support

Refund requests are reviewed manually and should be submitted within 14 days of purchase. Trial mode is available before purchase so users can confirm that the app can read their Music.app playlist and analyze local tracks.

- Refunds may be accepted when the software cannot be activated or cannot reasonably be used on a supported system after troubleshooting.
- Refunds may be declined after 14 days, if a license has been issued and the software works as described, or if the issue is caused by unsupported macOS versions, missing permissions, missing

backups, unsupported library setups, corrupted libraries, third-party tools, optional helper tools, or user actions outside intended use.

- If a refund, chargeback, payment dispute, fraud review, or manual license review results in revocation, the license may be disabled on the license server.
- After revocation, the app may stop accepting that license during a future license check. Trial mode remains available.

Support email

For support, send a clear description, your purchase email, app version, macOS version, License Request text, screenshots if useful, and logs or reports when available to sergeyappleservice@gmail.com.